

CHAPTER 3

LAKE ERIE ISLANDS

SOUTH BASS ISLAND | MIDDLE BASS ISLAND | NORTH BASS ISLAND | KELLEYS ISLAND

Ohio has over a dozen natural islands in Lake Erie's Western Basin, ranging in size from small rock outcroppings to large land masses. The largest island in Ohio is Kelleys Island (2,837 acres), followed by South Bass (1,523 acres), Middle Bass (771 acres), and North Bass (677 acres) islands. Johnson's Island (see Chapter 2) is in Sandusky Bay and is 300 acres. The remaining islands in Ohio are all smaller than 100 acres. Canada's Pelee Island is the largest island in Lake Erie (10,330 acres). The Lake Erie Island region is renowned for its natural resources, recreational opportunities, cultural attractions, tourism, and charm.

The shallowness of the Western Basin and shaping of the islands can be attributed to the occurrence of Silurian-age (416 to 435 million years ago) dolomite and Devonian-age (359 to 407 million years ago) limestone. These durable bedrock types were more resistant to the gouging and scouring forces of glacial ice, unlike the less-resistant shale to the east. The Lake Erie Islands are dolomite (Bass Islands) and limestone (Kelleys and Pelee islands) outcroppings that were not eroded away by the glaciers.

Evidence of the glaciers can be seen throughout the Lake Erie Islands region. Glacial grooves and striations are visible at Kelleys Island State Park, Middle Bass Island State Park, and South Bass Island State Park, as well as East Harbor State Park on the Ottawa County mainland (see Chapter 2). The grooves on Kelleys Island measure 430 feet long by 35 feet wide by 15 feet deep and are considered North America's finest example of exposed glacial grooves.

SOUTH BASS ISLAND Map 3.1

South Bass Island is the southernmost and most developed of the three Bass Islands. It is located approximately three miles north of Catawba Point. The village of Put-in-Bay occupies the central part of South Bass, while Put-in-Bay Township takes up the remainder of the island.

South Bass has been a popular tourist destination and summer resort since the end of the Civil War. It features many points of interest and offers many sightseeing opportunities and recreational attractions. There are 17 coastal access sites on the island, totaling a little over 2.2 miles of coast and including two swimming beaches, two boat launches, watercraft dockage, lakefront camping, and trails. South Bass Island Water Trail (part of the Lake Erie Islands Water Trail) circles the island and connects nine paddling locations at eight public access sites.

The topography of South Bass generally slopes from higher elevations on the west side to areas of very low relief with beaches on the east side. Rocky dolomite bluffs along the western shore reach heights of up to 40 feet in some areas, making shore access dangerous and prohibited at some sites. Downtown Put-in-Bay and surrounding harbor area is generally low-lying and at street/sidewalk level. Public access sites include docks, marinas, fishing structures, and a boat ramp. South Bass Island is accessible via ferry (from Port Clinton, Catawba Island, Sandusky, and Kelleys Island), airplane, and boat.

MIDDLE BASS ISLAND Map 3.1

Middle Bass Island is situated between South Bass and North Bass islands. It is located in Ottawa County and is part of Put-in-Bay Township. In 1679, French explorer Robert de LaSalle named the island "Isle de Fleures" (Island of Flowers) because of its many wildflowers. It was renamed Middle Bass Island in 1856.

The island's topography is flatter than that of South Bass and comparable to North Bass. Bluff heights are generally less than 15 feet. Beach and shore areas are accessible via short hiking trails or terrain. Middle Bass Island's northeastern extension is known as East Point. It connects to the greater part of the island via a narrow isthmus (occupied by Deist Road and Kuehnle Wildlife Area). The East Point peninsula is a little over one mile long by about 135 feet wide at its narrowest (east of Kuehnle Wildlife Area) to about 1,300 feet wide at its widest.



Middle Bass has four access sites—totaling 2.2 miles of coast—and offers a marina, boat ramp, primitive camping, and passive recreation opportunities. Middle Bass Island Water Trail (Lake Erie Islands Water Trail) circles the island and connects four paddling access sites. Middle Bass is accessible via ferry (from Catawba Island), water taxi (from Put-in-Bay), airplane, and boat.

NORTH BASS ISLAND Map 3.1

North Bass Island, also known as Isle St. George, is the northernmost, least developed, and least visited of the Bass Islands. It is located in Ottawa County and is part of Put-in-Bay Township. North Bass is 18 miles north of the Ohio mainland and less than two miles from the Canadian border. In 2004, the state of Ohio purchased 87 percent (589 acres) of the island’s total acreage to preserve it from development.

The island’s topography is comparable to Middle Bass. Bluffs are generally less than ten feet high. Beach and shore areas are accessible for fishing and paddling. North Bass has three public access sites—totaling 4.5 miles of coast—and offers passive recreational opportunities and tranquil landscapes. North Bass Island Water Trail (Lake Erie Islands Water Trail) circles the island and links five paddling locations. The island is accessible by airplane, private charter, and boat. Four public mooring balls are first-come, first-served. No public docks are available.

KELLEYS ISLAND Map 3.1

Kelleys Island is in Erie County and fully part of the village of Kelleys Island. It was originally referred to as “Island Number 6” and later Cunningham Island. In 1840, it was named Kelleys Island after brothers Datus and Irad Kelley. The two built shipping infrastructure and established timber operations, limestone quarries, orchards, and vineyards on the island.

Much like the topography of South Bass, Kelleys Island gradually slopes from higher elevations on the west side to lower relief with beaches on the east side. Bluff heights on the west side range from 10 to 20 feet high. In addition to its spectacular glacial grooves, Kelleys Island’s northwestern quadrant also features North Shore Alvar, an outcropping of limestone exposed by the glaciers along its shore. The alvar is a protected nature preserve and publicly accessible via trail. It is the best preserved, naturally intact alvar in Ohio, and features little to no surface soil, sparse vegetation, and glacial striations.

Kelleys Island is a popular tourist destination with many natural areas to explore. There are seven access sites on the island, totaling 1.4 miles of coast and including a swimming beach, boat launch, camping, hiking trails, and geologic points of interest. Kelleys Island Water Trail (Lake Erie Islands Water Trail) circles the island and connects five paddling locations. Kelleys is accessible via ferry (from Marblehead, Sandusky, and Put-in-Bay), airplane, and boat.

SOUTH BASS ISLAND SITES

- LEI1 South Bass Island Lighthouse
- LEI2 South Bass Island State Park
- LEI3 Captain Alfred Parker Park
- LEI4 West Shore Ice Ramp – South
- LEI5 West Shore Ice Ramp – North
- LEI6 Stone Laboratory Peach Point Campus
- LEI6 Put-in-Bay Aquatic Visitor Center
- LEI7 Oak Point State Park
- LEI8 Duff Homestead and Bayfront Preserve
- LEI9 DeRivera Park, including B Dock
- LEI10 Put-in-Bay Village Marina (A Dock and C Dock)
- LEI11 Put-in-Bay Public Boat Launch
- LEI12 Perry’s Victory and International Peace Memorial
- LEI13 Massie Cliffside Preserve
- LEI14 East Point
- LEI15 Scheeff East Point Nature Preserve
- LEI16 Put-in-Bay Bathing Beach
- LEI17 Put-in-Bay Port Authority Access

MIDDLE BASS ISLAND SITES

- LEI18 Middle Bass Island East Point Preserve
- LEI18.1 Middle Bass Island East Point Preserve – Cleveland Tract
- LEI19 Middle Bass Island State Park
- LEI20 Petersen Woods
- LEI21 Kuehnle Wildlife Area

NORTH BASS ISLAND SITES

- LEI22 North Bass Island State Park
- LEI23 Fox’s Marsh Wildlife Area
- LEI24 Honey Point Wildlife Area

KELLEYS ISLAND SITES

- LEI25 Scheele Preserve
- LEI26 Woodford Road Access (paddling rest stop only)
- LEI27 Inscription Rock Petroglyphs
- LEI28 Kelleys Island Scenic Overlook
- LEI29 North Shore Alvar State Nature Preserve
- LEI30 Kelleys Island State Park
- LEI30.1 Kelleys Island State Park – Glacial Grooves Geological Preserve
- LEI30.2 Kelleys Island State Park – East Quarry Area
- LEI31 North Pond State Nature Preserve

WATER TRAILS

- KI Lake Erie Islands Water Trail – Kelleys Island Trail
- MBI Lake Erie Islands Water Trail – Middle Bass Island Trail
- ML Lake Erie Islands Water Trail – Mainland Trail (see Chapter 2)
- NBI Lake Erie Islands Water Trail – North Bass Island Trail
- SBI Lake Erie Islands Water Trail – South Bass Island Trail



Lake Erie

OTTAWA
COUNTY

ERIE
COUNTY

Lake Erie

3.1 LAKE ERIE ISLANDS

- LEGEND
- Public Access Site
 - Public Access Site/Entrance
 - Interior Access Site
 - Pedestrian/Trail Entrance
 - Right-of-Way Access
 - Roadside Parking Lot
 - Water Trail

2 Miles



LAKE ERIE

LAKE ERIE

LEI1 South Bass Island Lighthouse

- End of Langram Road
Put-in Bay Township
South Bass Island
- Ohio State University

Amenities and Activities:



South Bass Island Lighthouse has been guiding ships through Lake Erie’s South Passage since 1897. The lighthouse is located at the southern tip (Lighthouse Point) of South Bass Island (end of Langram Road) in Put-in-Bay Township. It is a Queen Anne-style brick home with two-and-a-half stories of living space, full basement, and an attached 60-foot light tower. In 1967, Ohio State University assumed care of the home and grounds. The U.S. Coast Guard maintains the light. The three-acre site is open for foot traffic and features a butterfly garden, historic marker, picnic tables, golf cart parking, and scenic views of Lake Erie.

Water Access: No lake access
Scenic views of Lake Erie are accessible along top of bluff



LEI3 Captain Alfred Parker Park

- West Shore Boulevard at
Trenton Avenue
Put-in-Bay Township
South Bass Island
- Put-in-Bay Township

Amenities and Activities:



Captain Alfred Parker Park occupies green space within the Trenton Avenue right-of-way at West Shore Boulevard in Put-in-Bay Township. It includes two picnic tables, benches, and a bike rack. Green Island, a state-protected wildlife area (Green Island Wildlife Area; no access) is visible from the park. A fence prohibits access to the water. The park’s namesake, Captain Alfred Parker, was the skipper of a popular island ferry and a former township trustee.

Water Access: No lake access
Scenic views of Lake Erie are accessible along top of bluff

LEI2 South Bass Island State Park

- 1523 Catawba Avenue
Put-in-Bay Township
South Bass Island
- 41.6423, -82.8373
- ODNR Division of Parks and Watercraft

Amenities and Activities:



The 33-acre South Bass Island State Park is located on the west side of South Bass Island in Put-in-Bay Township. The park provides amenities for both day-use and overnight visitors, including a cobble beach, boat ramp, picnic facilities, fishing pier, campground, and playground. The campground offers 59 electric sites, 10 full-service sites, 57 non-electric sites, and three ‘cabents’ (combines the features of a cabin and a tent). The park property was the location of Hotel Victory, a 180,000 square-foot, 625-room hotel that opened in 1892. When built, it was one of the largest hotels in the world and featured a co-ed swimming pool, a rarity in its time. Fire destroyed the hotel in 1919. Remnants can be found in the campground. Small glacial grooves can also be found in the campground.

Water Access:

- Cobble beach is accessible for swimming via boat ramp and terrain
- Lake Erie is accessible for fishing, boating, and paddling via pier and boat ramp
- Bluff restricts lake access within campground

Water Trail:

-  Lake Erie Islands Water Trail – South Bass Island Trail
- Put-in-Bay Port Authority Access (1.8 miles south, around Lighthouse Point)
- West Shore Ice Ramp (1.1 miles northwest, clockwise around island)

Lake Erie Birding Trail:

-  Lake Erie Islands Loop

LEI4-5 West Shore Ice Ramps

- South Ice Ramp**
West Shore Boulevard,
south of Mitchell Road
Put-in-Bay Township
South Bass Island
- North Ice Ramp**
West Shore Boulevard,
northeast of Portsmouth Road
Put-in-Bay Township
South Bass Island

Amenities and Activities:

South Ice Ramp



North Ice Ramp



-  41.6538, -82.8372 (South)
41.6580, -82.8298 (North)
- Put-in-Bay Township

There are two publicly accessible ice ramps located along West Shore Boulevard on the west side of South Bass Island. Both sites are utilized as emergency boat launches and for paddling, fishing, and winter lake access. The south ramp (pictured to right) offers parking, a bench, and is an access site on the Lake Erie Islands Water Trail (South Bass Island Trail). There are no amenities at the north ramp.

Water Access:
Lake Erie is accessible for fishing and paddling via ice ramps

Water Trail:

-  Lake Erie Islands Water Trail – South Bass Island Trail (from South Ramp)
- South Bass Island State Park (1.1 miles south)
- Oak Point State Park (1.2 miles north, around Peach Orchard Point)





Oak Point State Park

LAKE ERIE

LEI6 Stone Laboratory Peach Point Campus

State Route 357
and West Shore Boulevard
Put-in-Bay Township
South Bass Island

Ohio State University and
ODNR Division of Wildlife

Ohio State University's Stone Laboratory is the oldest freshwater biological field station in the United States (established in 1895). The lab offers various research and teaching workshops and applied field opportunities focusing on biology, geology, natural resources, and Great Lakes/Lake Erie issues. The main campus is located on Gibraltar Island (within Put-in-Bay Harbor). Stone Laboratory's Peach Point campus includes paved walkways, public fishing dock, fishing equipment (to borrow), bait, courtesy docks, small picnic area, and benches.

Put-in-Bay Aquatic Visitor Center (open seasonally) was fully renovated in 2024 and offers hands-on exhibits that highlight fish species, fish anatomy, fisheries management, and invasive species. Admission is free.

Amenities and Activities:



LEI7 Oak Point State Park

Bayview Avenue (SR 357)
at Portsmouth Avenue
Put-in-Bay Township
South Bass Island

41.6563, -82.8257

The 1.5-acre Oak Point State Park is the smallest state park in Ohio. The triangle-shaped park juts into Put-in-Bay Harbor and points toward Gibraltar Island. Oak Point offers daily and overnight dockage, fishing access, a small picnic area, restrooms, and scenic views.

Amenities and Activities:



LEI8 Duff Homestead and Bayfront Preserve

Amenities and Activities:



The 6.5-acre Duff Homestead and Bayfront Preserve (Put-in-Bay Township Park District) features 150 feet of waterfront, a birding trail through mature woods, pollinator habitat (with perimeter trail), benches, visitor center, and scenic views of Put-in-Bay Harbor.

Water Access:

- Fishing pier accessible via walkway
- Courtesy docks available to boaters



Water Access:

- Fishing and scenic views of Put-in-Bay Harbor accessible along walkway
- Docks available to boaters

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
South Bass Island Trail

- West Shore Ice Ramp (1.2 miles north, around Peach Orchard Point)
- Put-in-Bay Public Boat Launch (0.6 miles east)

ODNR Division of Parks and Watercraft

LEI9 DeRivera Park, including B Dock

Bayview Avenue (SR 357) between
Catawba and Hartford avenues
Put-in-Bay
South Bass Island

41.6539, -82.8174

DeRivera Park Trust

Amenities and Activities:



B Dock



DeRivera Park is located in downtown Put-in-Bay. It is bounded by Catawba, Delaware, and Hartford avenues to the west, south, and east, respectively. Bayview Avenue (State Route 357), to the north, divides the parkland area (to south) and the park's dock and harbor-side walkway (to north). DeRivera Park Trust, formed in 1866, operates and maintains the park's B Dock at Put-in-Bay's public marina. The trust also helps protect the park and aids upkeep. The dock has daily and overnight rates. DeRivera Park features War of 1812, World War I, and World War II memorials, fountain, gazebo, picnic area, playground, and bathhouse.

LEI10-11 Put-in-Bay Village Marina
(A Dock and C Dock) and Public Boat Launch

Village Marina
Bayview Avenue (SR 357) between
Catawba and Hartford avenues
Put-in-Bay
South Bass Island

Amenities and Activities:



Boat Launch
Bayview Avenue (SR 357)
at Hartford Avenue
Put-in-Bay
South Bass Island

41.6539, -82.8174

41.6537, -82.8187 (A Dock)
41.6541, -82.8163 (C Dock)

41.6541, -82.8160

Village of Put-in-Bay

Put-in-Bay Village Marina is located on Bayview Avenue (State Route 357) in downtown Put-in-Bay. The village operates the marina's A Dock and C Dock. Pedestrians may walk the length of each dock. The marina has daily and overnight rates. Electric and water hook-ups are available. An accessible sidewalk with benches runs the length of the harbor. A public boat launch (pictured to right) is located on SR 357 at Hartford Avenue, east of C Dock.



Put-in-Bay Village Marina

LAKE ERIE

Water Access:

- Public marina B Dock accessible via harbor and walkway
- Fishing available along walkway

Mooring Field

The Put-in-Bay downtown harbor mooring field offers 76 mooring buoys that can accommodate vessels 52 feet and under, and six buoys for boats over 52 feet long. The mooring field is owned by the Put-in-Bay Port Authority and operated by Boardwalk Harbor Operations. It is first-come, first-served (no reservations) and cash only (daily and overnight rates). Water taxi service is available.

Water Access:

- Public marina A Dock and C Dock are accessible via harbor and walkway
- Lake Erie is accessible for boating via boat ramp

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
South Bass Island Trail (from boat launch)

Oak Point State Park (0.6 miles west)

Massie Cliffside Preserve (1.1 miles northeast)





LAKE ERIE

LAKE ERIE

LE112

Perry's Victory and International Peace Memorial

93 Delaware Avenue
Put-in Bay
South Bass Island

National Park Service

Amenities and Activities:



Perry's Victory and International Peace Memorial was built to commemorate the United States' naval triumph in the Battle of Lake Erie during the War of 1812 and to celebrate long-lasting peace between the United States, Canada, and the United Kingdom. It is named after Master Commandant Oliver Hazard Perry, who led the American fleet to victory. The 352-foot-tall monument was constructed between 1912 and 1915 and was added to the national park system in 1936. It is the world's tallest Doric-style column and third tallest U.S. memorial. An open-air, 317-foot-high observation platform provides panoramic views of Lake Erie and surrounding islands (fee). The visitor center includes interpretive displays, theater, restrooms, and gift shop.

Water Access:

Lake Erie is accessible for fishing and scenic views along north and south seawalls

Nearby Sites:

Put-in-Bay Village Beach is adjacent to the south

Fees:

Observation platform (atop memorial)

Scenic views of Lake Erie and fishing access are available along the north and south seawalls. Paved paths directly parallel the seawalls and lead to observation patios with benches.

LE115

Scheeff East Point Nature Preserve

End of Columbus Avenue (SR 357)
Put-in-Bay Township
South Bass Island

41.6652, -82.7939 (North)
41.6639, -82.7943 (East)

Put-in-Bay Township Park District

Amenities and Activities:



The nine-acre Scheeff East Point Nature Preserve is located on the northeastern tip of South Bass Island at the terminus of Columbus Avenue (State Route 357). The passive-use preserve includes a trail around its perimeter, beach access, benches, and two water trail landing sites. Rocky shores and upland vegetation provide habitat for the Lake Erie water snake, migratory songbirds, waterfowl, and butterflies. Scheeff East Point also offers fishing access, birding opportunities, and scenic views of Lake Erie. In an effort to address erosion concerns and enhance existing habitat, a nature-based shoreline was installed in 2024.

LE113

Massie Cliffside Preserve

Columbus Avenue (SR 357)
Put-in-Bay Township
South Bass Island

41.6631, -82.8067

Put-in-Bay Township Park District

Amenities and Activities:



The 11-acre Massie Cliffside Preserve is a wooded site offering passive recreational activities, including hiking, fishing, paddling, birding, and nature photography. The 1,750-foot-long "Ken's Trail" connects the preserve's parking areas with the lakefront, where a fishing pier, benches, and small beach can be found. A wooden fence lines much of the shoreline atop the dolomite bluff.

Water Access:

Lake Erie is accessible for fishing and paddling via trail and stairs (launch from beach)

Trails:

Ken's Trail

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
South Bass Island Trail

Put-in-Bay Public Boat Launch (1.1 miles southwest)

Scheeff East Point Nature Preserve,
North access (0.6 miles east)

LE116-17

Put-in-Bay Bathing Beach and Put-in-Bay Port Authority Access

Bathing Beach
End of Delaware Avenue
Put-in-Bay
South Bass Island

Port Authority Access
Airline Road,
southeast of Langram Road
Put-in-Bay Township
South Bass Island

41.6528, -82.8126 (Beach)
41.6320, -82.8311 (Port Authority)

Amenities and Activities:



Port Authority Access



Village of Put-in-Bay and
Put-in-Bay Port Authority

Put-in-Bay Bathing Beach is located at the eastern end of Delaware Avenue, adjacent and south of Perry's Victory and International Peace Memorial. The 95-foot-wide sand beach has a picnic table, bench, allows fishing, and provides paddling access to the Lake Erie Islands Water Trail's South Bass Island loop.

The Put-in-Bay Port Authority site is located on Airline Road (private road) and provides access to the South Bass Island paddling loop.

Water Access:

Lake Erie is accessible for fishing and paddling via trail (launch from beach)

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
South Bass Island Trail (two points)

Massie Cliffside Preserve (0.6 miles west from the North access or 1.2 miles from the East access, around Buckeye Island)

Put-in-Bay Bathing Beach (1.5 miles southwest from the East access or 2.1 miles from the North access, around Buckeye Island)

Lake Erie Birding Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Loop

Water Access:

Bathing Beach: Lake Erie beach is accessible for swimming, fishing, and paddling via walkway and terrain (launch from beach)

Port Authority Access: Lake Erie is accessible for paddling via terrain (launch from beach)

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
South Bass Island Trail

Put-in-Bay Bathing Beach and Put-in-Bay Port Authority Access are 2.0 miles apart

Scheeff East Point Nature Preserve (1.5 miles northeast from Bathing Beach)

South Bass Island State Park (1.8 miles southwest from Port Authority Access, around Lighthouse Point)



LAKE ERIE

LE118

Middle Bass Island East Point Preserve

End of North Shore Road
Put-in-Bay Township
Middle Bass Island

41.6956, -82.7818

Put-in-Bay Township Park District

The 11-acre Middle Bass Island East Point Preserve (including the adjacent Cleveland Tract) is located on North Shore Road (private road) at the northeastern tip of Middle Bass Island. *It is only accessible by kayak or canoe.* Passive-use amenities include a hiking trail, picnic table, bench, and fishing access. A small dock/pier is available.

Amenities and Activities:



LE119

Middle Bass Island State Park

1719 Fox Road
Put-in-Bay Township
Middle Bass Island

41.6758, -82.8092

41.6761, -82.8110

41.6761, -82.8110 (boat ramp)
41.6732, -82.8140 (west)

ODNR Division of Parks and Watercraft

Middle Bass Island State Park is in the southern portion of Middle Bass Island and boasts a 184-slip marina, which provides seasonal dockage for island residents and transient dockage for visitors. Marina amenities include electric and water hook-up, boat launch, shower house, and restrooms. Overnight dockage is available by reservation. The park's 10 primitive campsites do not have electric service or potable water. Lonz Mansion (renovated in 2024) is also available for seasonal overnight stays. The 1.3-mile ADA Lonz Trail is a north-south paved multiuse trail that connects points of interest within the park, including the marina, glacial grooves, and historic Lonz Winery grounds. The renovated Lonz Winery building includes a patio overlooking Lake Erie and winemaking exhibits.

Amenities and Activities:



Water Access:

- Fishing permitted along shore and from kayaks/canoes (*no access from land*)
- Dock available to paddlers to access preserve

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
Middle Bass Island Trail

- Petersen Woods and Kuehnle Wildlife Area (1.9 miles east, around East Point)
- Middle Bass Island State Park, marina access (2.7 miles west, clockwise around island)

Water Access:

- Lake Erie is accessible for fishing, boating, and paddling via marina and boat ramp
- Docks available to boaters at marina
- Lake Erie beach is accessible for fishing, paddling, and scenic views via terrain

Trails:

- Campground Loop Trail
- Old Campground Trail
- Rocky Shore Trail
- ADA Lonz Trail

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
Middle Bass Island Trail (two points)

- Middle Bass Island East Point Preserve (2.7 miles north from marina access)
- Petersen Woods and Kuehnle Wildlife Area (2.6 miles north from the West access or 3.9 miles from marina access)

Lake Erie Birding Trail:

- Lake Erie Islands Loop

LE120-21

Kuehnle Wildlife Area and Petersen Woods

Deist Road, east of Fox Road
Put-in-Bay Township
Middle Bass Island

41.6905, -82.8068

ODNR Division of Wildlife and
Put-in-Bay Township Park District

Amenities and Activities:

Kuehnle Wildlife Area



Petersen Woods



The 20-acre Kuehnle Wildlife Area and two-acre Petersen Woods are adjacent sites on the north side of Middle Bass Island. Kuehnle is a triangle-shaped fishing and wildlife viewing area that spans the narrow isthmus connecting the greater part of Middle Bass to the island's East Point. Hauncks Pond occupies much of the wildlife area. Waterfowl hunting is available within the marsh and along the Lake Erie shoreline.

Petersen Woods is an undeveloped woodlot that offers fishing access, paddling access, and wildlife viewing. There are no amenities at either site.

LE122

North Bass Island State Park

Occupies much of North Bass Island
Put-in-Bay Township
North Bass Island

41.7074, -82.8162 (South)
41.7227, -82.8257 (North)
41.7185, -82.8119 (East)

ODNR Division of Parks and Watercraft

Amenities and Activities:



The 593-acre North Bass Island State Park occupies 67 percent of North Bass Island. The park offers three primitive campsites (first-come, first-served) and is available for bicycling, hiking, wildlife viewing, and low-impact outdoor activities. Fishing is permitted in appropriate locations along the park's 3.5 miles of shore. Hunting is permitted in designated areas. The four-bedroom Lake House provides seasonal accommodations for 10 to 12 overnight guests. North Bass is the northernmost island in Ottawa County and less than two miles from the Canadian border. It is accessible via private boat, charter, and airplane. The park offers four public mooring buoys on the south side of the island (first-come, first-served) and paddling access to the North Bass Island paddling loop.



LAKE ERIE

Water Access:

Lake Erie is accessible for fishing and paddling via primitive terrain

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
Middle Bass Island Trail

- Middle Bass Island State Park (2.6 miles west to West access)
- Middle Bass Island East Point Preserve (1.9 miles east, around East Point)

Lake Erie Birding Trail:

- Lake Erie Islands Loop

Nearby Sites:

Kuehnle Wildlife Area and Petersen Woods are adjacent sites (no trail connections)

Water Access:

Lake Erie is accessible for fishing and paddling via terrain

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
North Bass Island Trail (three points)

- Honey Point Wildlife Area (0.4 miles east from the South access or 1.2 miles south (➡) from the East access, around Honey Point)
- Fox's Marsh Wildlife Area (1.5 miles west from the South access or 0.9 miles south (⬅) from the North access)

Lake Erie Birding Trail:

- Lake Erie Islands Loop

Nearby Sites:

- Honey Point Wildlife Area is adjacent to the southeast (no trail connections)
- Fox's Marsh Wildlife Area is adjacent to the west (no trail connections)



LAKE ERIE



LAKE ERIE

LEI23

Fox's Marsh Wildlife Area

Western North Bass Island
Put-in-Bay Township
North Bass Island

41.7120, -82.8311

ODNR Division of Wildlife

Amenities and Activities:



The 132-acre Fox's Marsh Wildlife Area is located in the southwestern quadrant of North Bass Island and fronts one half mile of publicly accessible Lake Erie shore. It includes one quarter mile of beach along Manila Bay. It is bound by North Bass Island State Park to the north, east, and southwest. Fox's Marsh, a 60-acre coastal wetland, supports fox snake, Lake Erie water snake, waterfowl, migratory shorebird, and songbird populations. The wildlife area is accessible for fishing, hunting, wildlife viewing, and paddling. Swimming is prohibited.

LEI24

Honey Point Wildlife Area

Southeast tip of North Bass Island
Put-in-Bay Township
North Bass Island

41.7074, -82.8083

ODNR Division of Wildlife

Amenities and Activities:



Honey Point Wildlife Area occupies the southeastern tip of North Bass Island. The Honey Point peninsula points in a southeasterly direction toward Middle Bass Island's East Point. The wildlife area is adjacent to North Bass Island State Park and is not accessible by road. A small wetland area located in the center of the site, known as Smith's Pond, provides nesting areas for waterfowl and habitat for shorebirds and songbirds. Honey Point Wildlife Area is accessible for fishing, hunting, wildlife viewing, and paddling. Swimming is prohibited.

Water Access:

Lake Erie is accessible for fishing and paddling

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
North Bass Island Trail

- North Bass Island State Park, South access (1.5 miles south, counterclockwise around island)
- North Bass Island State Park, North access (0.9 miles north)

Nearby Sites:

North Bass Island State Park is adjacent to the north, east and southwest (no trail connections)

LEI25

Scheele Preserve

Monagan Road,
north of Hamilton Road
Kelleys Island

41.6107, -82.6810

Cleveland Museum of Natural History

Amenities and Activities:



Scheele Preserve (pictured to right) is in the northeastern part of Kelleys Island. It is one of multiple island preserves protected by the Cleveland Museum of Natural History and the only one open to the public. A primitive trail meanders through open meadow, Juniper savannahs, and swamp forest to a 490-foot-long sandy beach. A picnic table is near the parking lot.

LEI26

Woodford Road Access (paddling rest stop)

Woodford Road Access is a resting stop on the Lake Erie Islands Water Trail (Kelleys Island loop). *It is only accessible from Lake Erie.* Scheele Preserve is 1.4 miles north (paddle left) and Inscription Rock Petroglyphs is 2.1 miles south/west (paddle right).

LEI27-28

Inscription Rock Petroglyphs and Kelleys Island Scenic Overlook

Inscription Rock
East Lakeshore Drive
at Addison Avenue
Kelleys Island

Scenic Overlook
West Lakeshore Drive (SR 575)
near Cameron Road
Kelleys Island

Amenities and Activities:



Scenic Overlook



Ohio History Connection

Inscription Rock is a limestone boulder that features Native American petroglyph drawings of animal and human figures, estimated to be less than 1,000 years old. The shelter and viewing platform were built in 1969.

A scenic overlook is located on West Lakeshore Drive (State Route 575), west of downtown. It offers a picnic table, benches, and binoculars.

Water Access:

Lake Erie beach is accessible for paddling and scenic views via trail

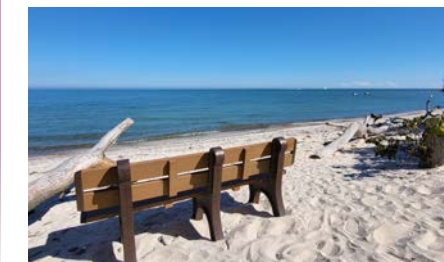
Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
Kelleys Island Trail

- North Pond State Nature Preserve (2.8 miles north, around Long Point)
- Woodford Road Access (1.4 miles south)

Lake Erie Birding Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Loop



Water Access:

- Inscription Rock: Lake Erie is accessible for paddling via terrain
- Scenic Overlook: Scenic views of Lake Erie are accessible from sidewalk

Water Trail:

Lake Erie Islands Water Trail –
Kelleys Island Trail (from Inscription Rock)

- Woodford Road Access (2.1 miles south, counterclockwise around island)
- Kelleys Island State Park (5.1 miles west, clockwise around island)



LAKE ERIE

LAKE ERIE

LEI30

Kelleys Island State Park

- Main Entrance**
920 Division Street
Kelleys Island
- East Quarry Trails**
Parking lot off Ward Road
Kelleys Island
- 41.6168, -82.7039
- ODNR Division of Parks and Watercraft

Amenities and Activities:

Kelleys Island State Park is in the northwestern and central portions of Kelleys Island. The 677-acre state park features amenities for day-use and overnight visitors, including a 100-foot swimming beach, a double-lane boat launch, courtesy dock, and five picnic areas. The park’s 127-site campground has a volleyball court, playground, camp store, and shower facilities. Two Yurts and two Sherman cabins are also available to reserve. Kelleys Island State Park features over 11 miles of hiking trails, including the 1.3-mile North Shore Alvar Loop, the 0.3-mile Glacial Grooves Quarry Trail, the 0.2-mile Alvar Trail, and nearly five miles of East Quarry trails. Remnants of a limestone crusher building are located along the North Shore Alvar Loop (at the Alvar Trail trailhead). North Shore Alvar and North Pond state nature preserves are adjacent to the state park property. The Alvar Trail and North Shore Alvar Loop provide access to North Shore Alvar State Nature Preserve. Kelleys Island State Park allows fishing, limited hunting (in designated areas), and wildlife viewing. A dog swimming area is marked at the beach. The park also features 20 acres of pollinator habitat.

LEI30.1

Glacial Grooves Geological Preserve

Amenities and Activities:

Glacial Grooves Geological Preserve, a National Natural Landmark, can be found within Kelleys Island State Park, west of the swimming beach. The site showcases the finest example of exposed glacial grooves in North America. It measures 430 feet long, 35 feet wide, and up to 15 feet deep. The grooves were scoured into the solid limestone bedrock about 18,000 years ago by massive ice sheets. A walking trail (with stairs, overlook areas, and educational signage) circles the landmark.

LEI30.2

East Quarry Area

Amenities and Activities:

The East Quarry Area comprises much of central Kelleys Island and features the East Quarry trails, a five-mile network of hiking and mountain biking trails. The trails traverse woodlands and an abandoned limestone quarry. Parking is available on Ward Road across from North Pond State Nature Preserve. Additional trailheads are located on Division Street (west), Monagan Road (east), and Woodford Road (south). Fishing is permitted at Horseshoe Lake.

LEI29

North Shore Alvar State Nature Preserve

- Northern Kelleys Island
Kelleys Island
- ODNR Division of
Natural Areas and Preserves

Amenities and Activities:

North Shore Alvar State Nature Preserve is located on the north side of Kelleys Island within Kelleys Island State Park. Alvars are glacially exposed limestone or dolomite bedrock outcroppings with little to no surface soil and sparse vegetation. North Shore Alvar is frequently scoured by wind, waves, and ice, which limits the diversity of sustainable vegetation. Only a few specially adapted plant species can survive the alvar’s terrain and conditions. North Shore Alvar is reachable via the 1.3-mile North Shore Alvar Loop trail and 0.2-mile Alvar Trail. Trailheads are accessible from the state park’s boat ramp parking area. There are no amenities at the nature preserve.

LEI31

North Pond State Nature Preserve

- Ward Road, east of Division Street
Kelleys Island
- 41.6115, -82.6990
- ODNR Division of
Natural Areas and Preserves

Amenities and Activities:

The 36.5-acre North Pond State Nature Preserve is in the northern part of Kelleys Island, adjacent to Kelleys Island State Park. The preserve’s entrance is on the north side of Ward Road, opposite the parking lot, one-half mile east of Division Street. North Pond is one of the last remaining natural wetland environments directly connected to Lake Erie. It is a lake embayment that is usually separated from Lake Erie’s North Bay by a sandbar. The pond itself formed as a result of the lake receding from an ancient shore. The remnant waterline crosses through the site. North Pond State Nature Preserve features 0.75 miles of trails (including boardwalk), information kiosks, raised observation platform, and beach. The preserve offers birding opportunities and many observable wetland plant species.

Water Access: No lake access
Scenic views of Lake Erie are available at alvar (accessible via trails)

- Trails:**
- Alvar Trail [↗](#)
 - North Shore Alvar Loop [↗](#)

Lake Erie Birding Trail:

- Lake Erie Islands Loop

Nearby Sites:
Kelleys Island State Park is adjacent to the south and connected via the Alvar Trail and North Shore Alvar Loop

Water Access:
Lake Erie beach is accessible via trail and from Kelleys Island State Park beach

- Trails:**
- North Pond Trail

Water Trail:

- Lake Erie Islands Water Trail – Kelleys Island Trail
- Kelleys Island State Park (0.4 miles west)
- Scheele Preserve (2.8 miles east, around Long Point)

Lake Erie Birding Trail:

- Lake Erie Islands Loop

Nearby Sites:
Kelleys Island State Park is adjacent to the northwest and connected via the beach